

WINDOWS SERVER 2022 • ACTIVE DIRECTORY

# Map Network Drive Using Group Policy (GPO) On ADDS

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## Lab Overview

This hands-on Windows Server 2022 lab focused on configuring and deploying mapped network drives using Group Policy Objects (GPO) within an Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS) environment. Practical experience was gained in creating shared folders, configuring drive mappings, linking Group Policies to Organizational Units (OU), managing user access, and verifying policy deployment on domain-joined client computers.

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## Objective

Configure Group Policy to automatically map shared network drives for domain users when they log in.

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## Environment

- Windows Server 2022
  - Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS)
  - Domain: sudeep.local
  - Server Name: winserver2022
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## Tools Used

- Group Policy Management
  - Active Directory Users and Computers
  - File Explorer
  - Shared Folders Management
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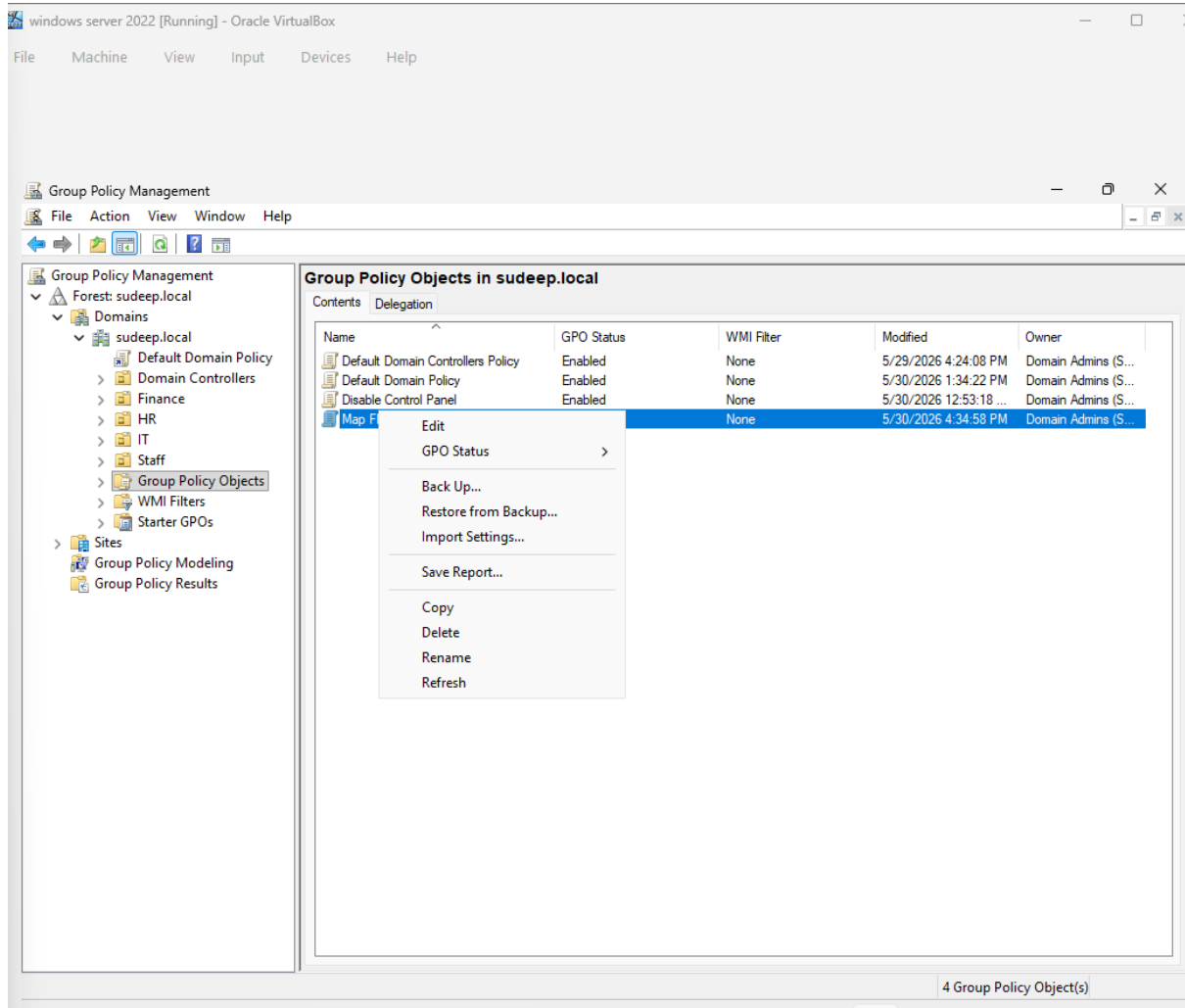
## Topics Covered

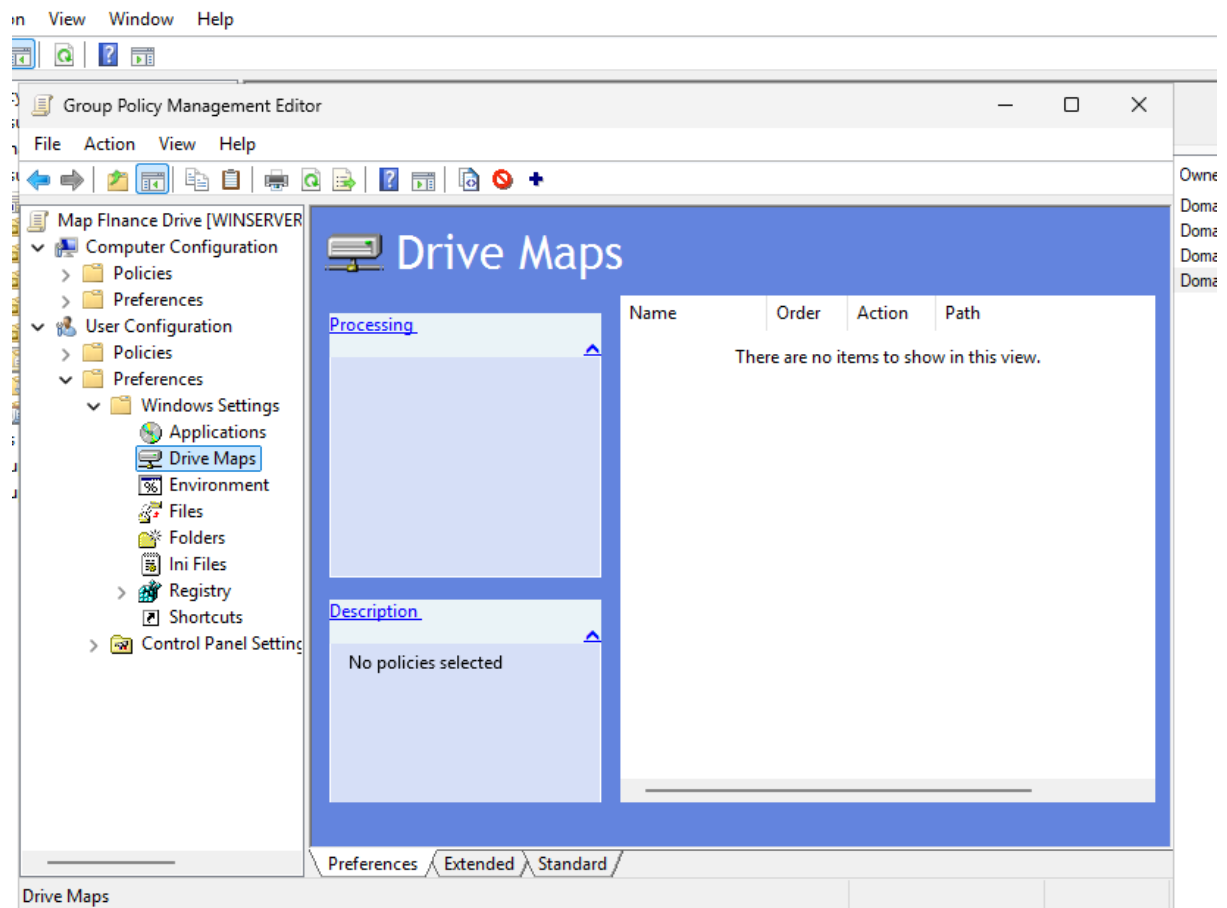
- Creating a new Group Policy Object (GPO)
  - Configuring Drive Maps in User Configuration Preferences
  - Linking a GPO to an Organisational Unit
  - Verifying GPO inheritance in Active Directory
  - Moving users between Organisational Units
  - Sharing folders and setting permissions for domain users
  - Testing GPO application on a client VM
  - Using gpupdate /force to apply policies
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# Procedure

## Step 1 — Create the Map Finance Drive GPO

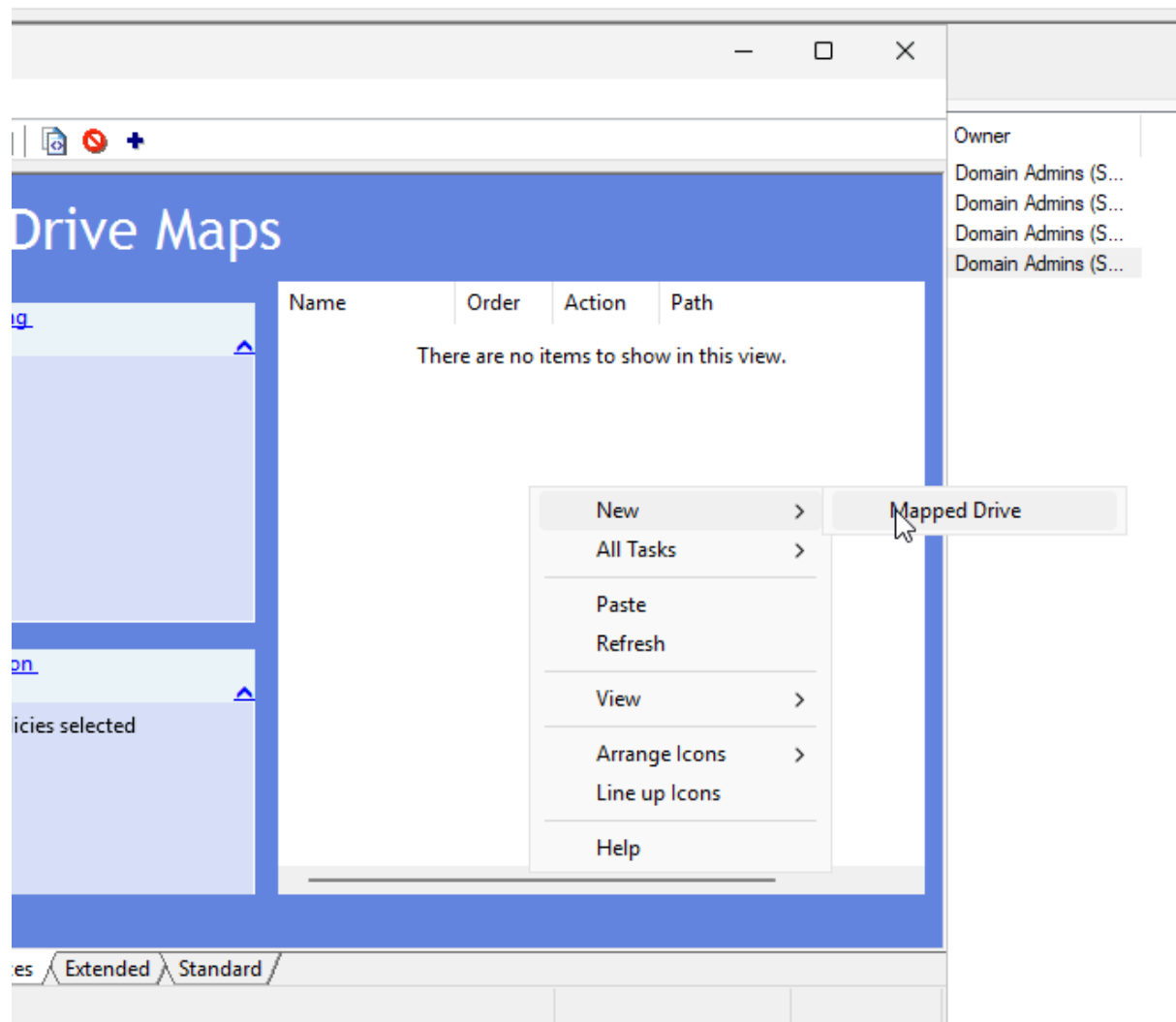
Open Server Manager → Tools → Group Policy Management. Right-click Group Policy Objects and select New. Name the new GPO Map Finance Drive.

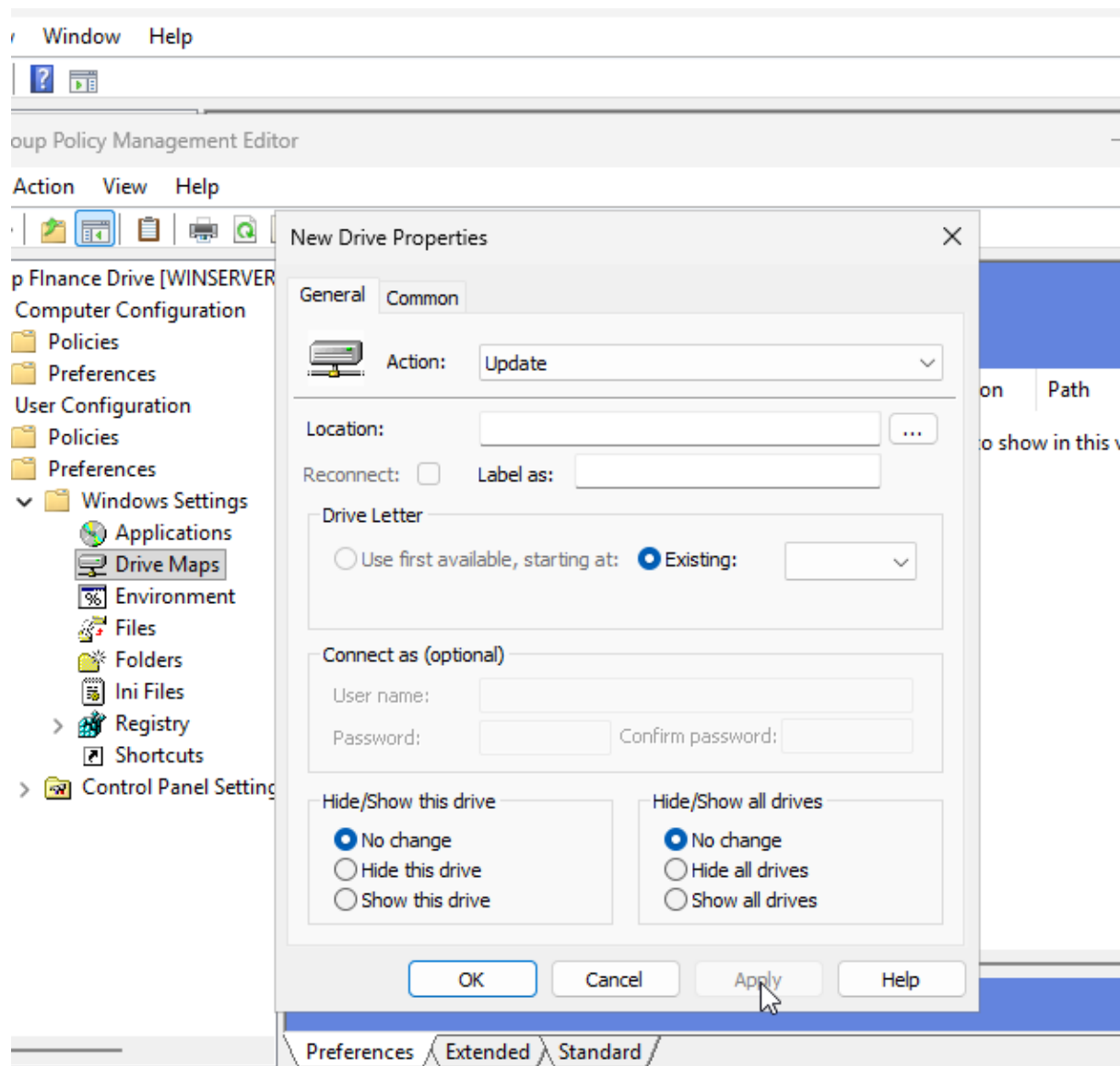


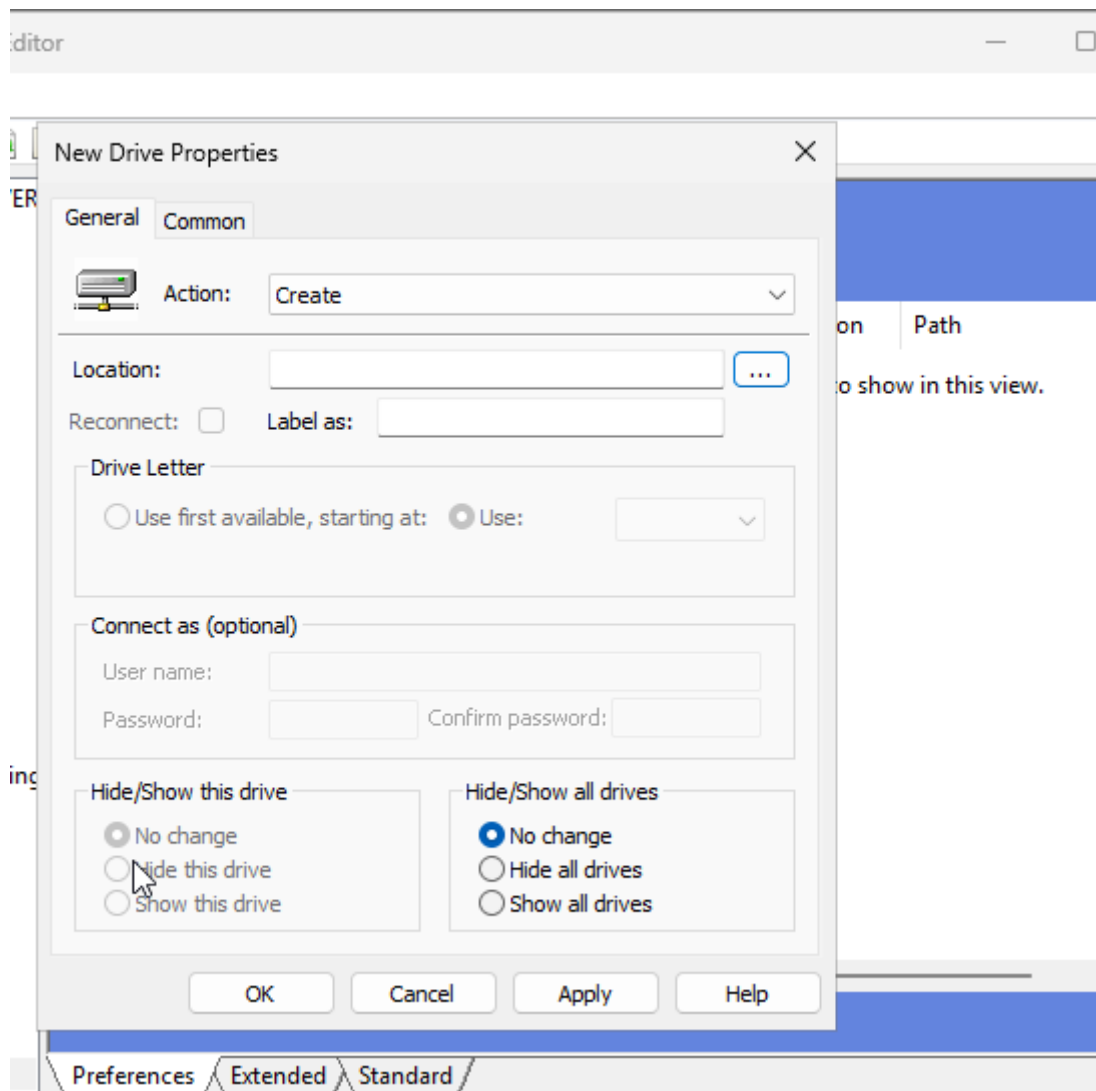


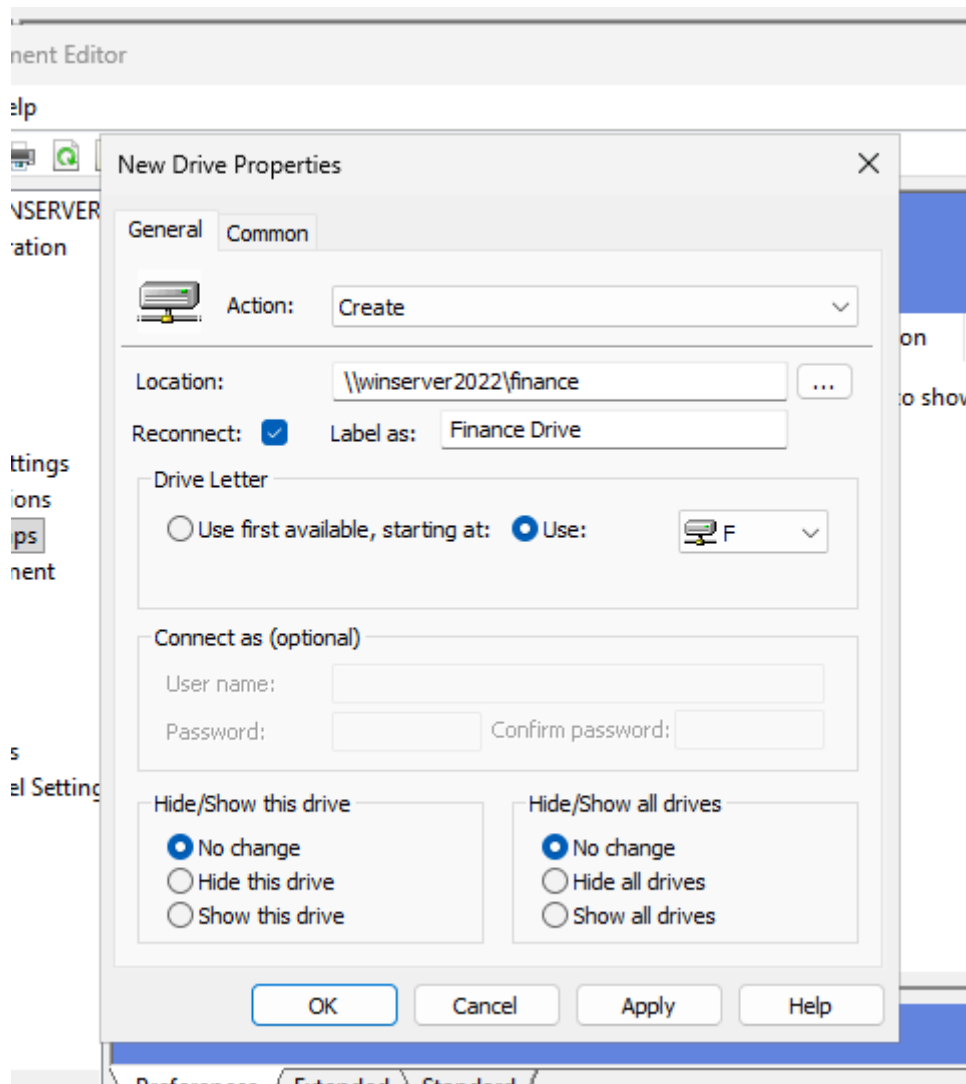
## Step 2 — Configure Drive Map Settings

Edit the GPO and navigate to: User Configuration → Preferences → Windows Settings → Drive Maps. Configure the drive mapping settings for the F: drive pointing to the shared CompanyData folder.





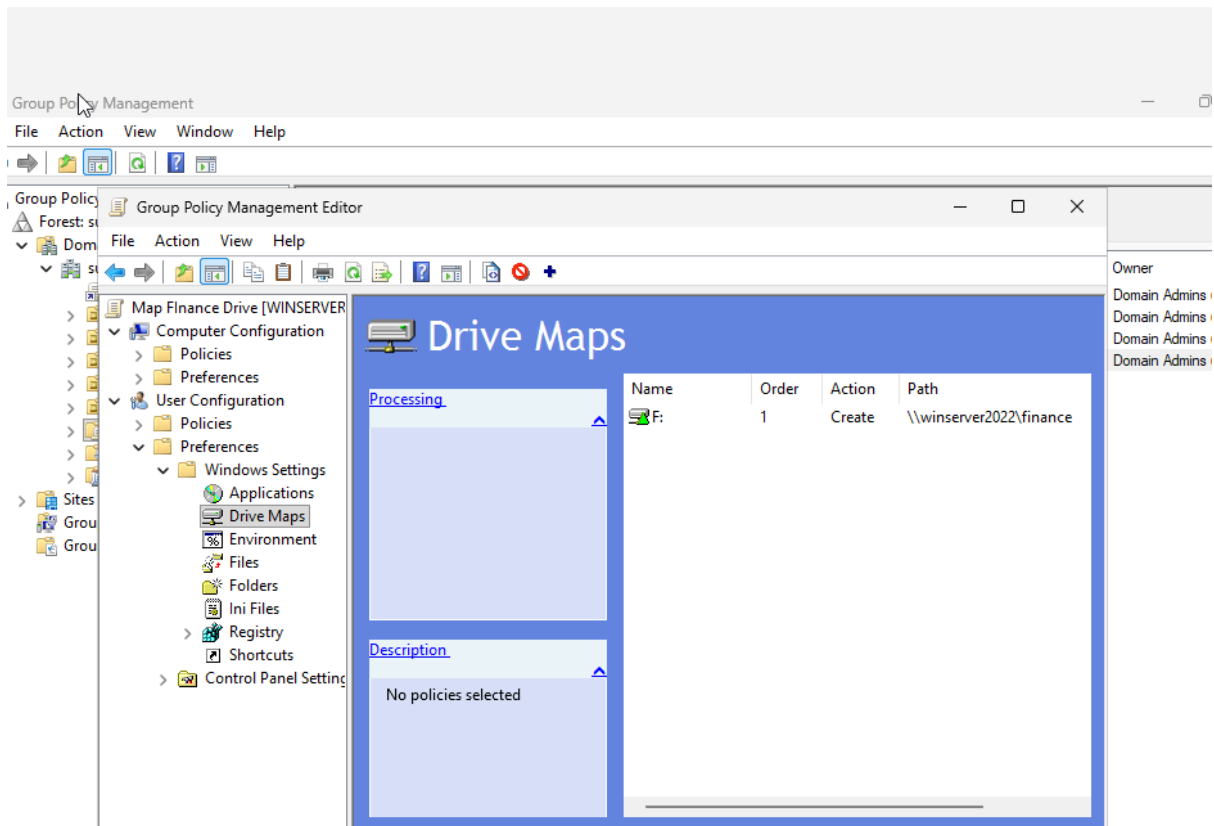






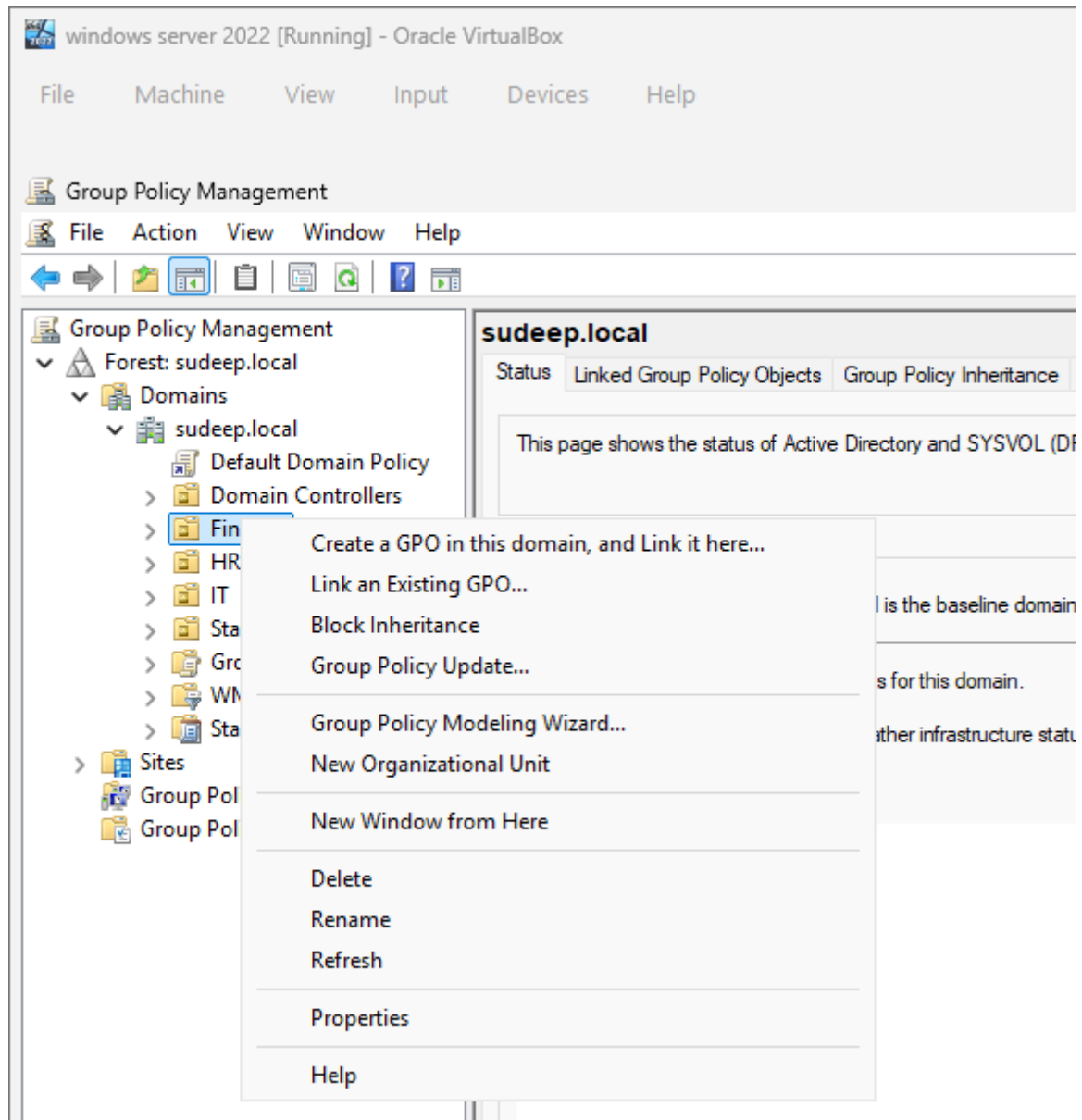
### Step 3 — Drive Mapping Created Successfully

The drive mapping has been created successfully in the GPO editor.



## Step 4 — Link GPO to the Finance OU

In Group Policy Management, right-click the Finance OU under sudeep.local and select Link an Existing GPO. Choose Map Finance Drive and click OK.



## sudeep.local

Status **Linked Group Policy Objects** Group Policy Inheritance Delegation

This page shows the status of Active Directory and SYSVOL (DFS) replication for this domain as it relates to Group Policy.

Select GPO

Look in this domain:

sudeep.local

Group Policy objects:

Name

Default Domain Controllers Policy

Default Domain Policy

Disable Control Panel

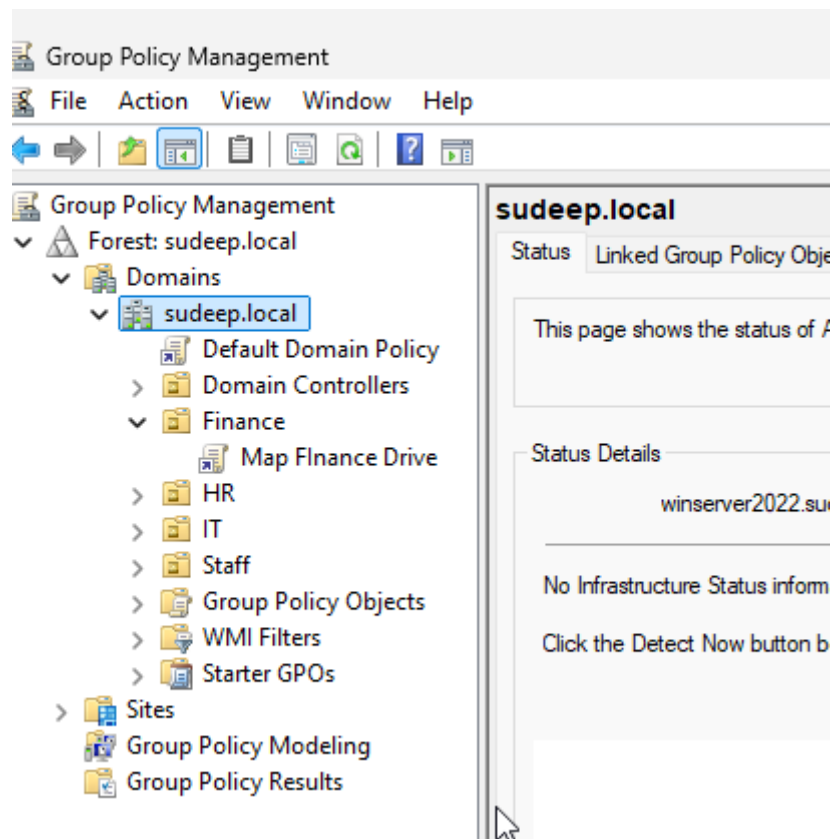
Map Finance Drive

OK

Cancel

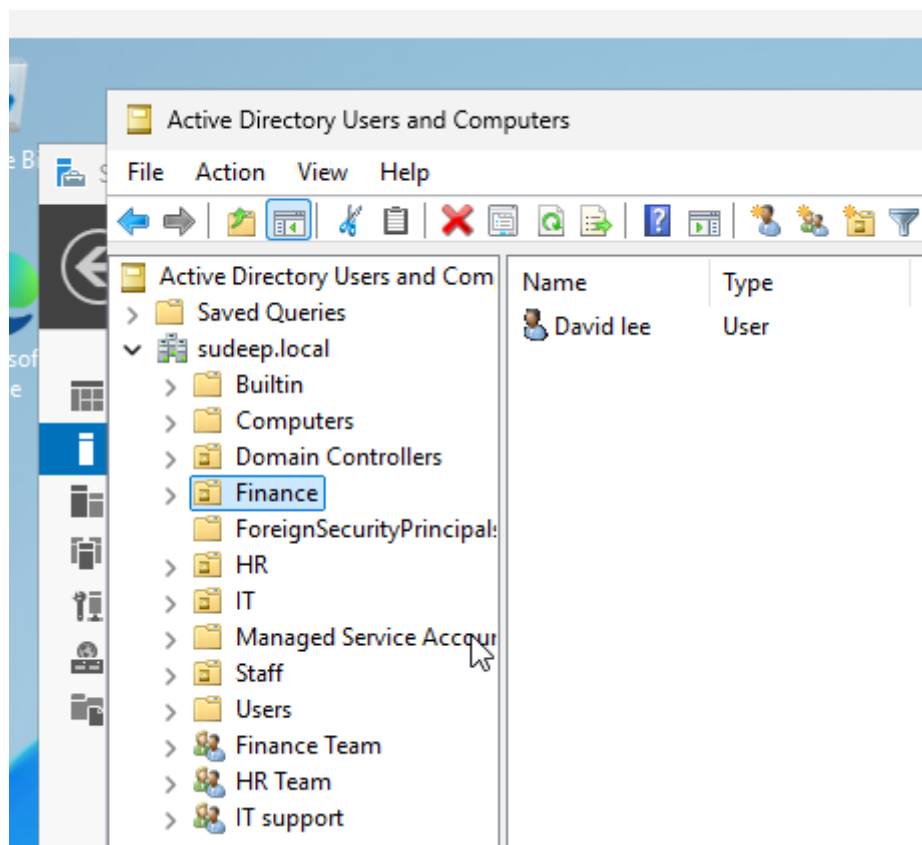
Search





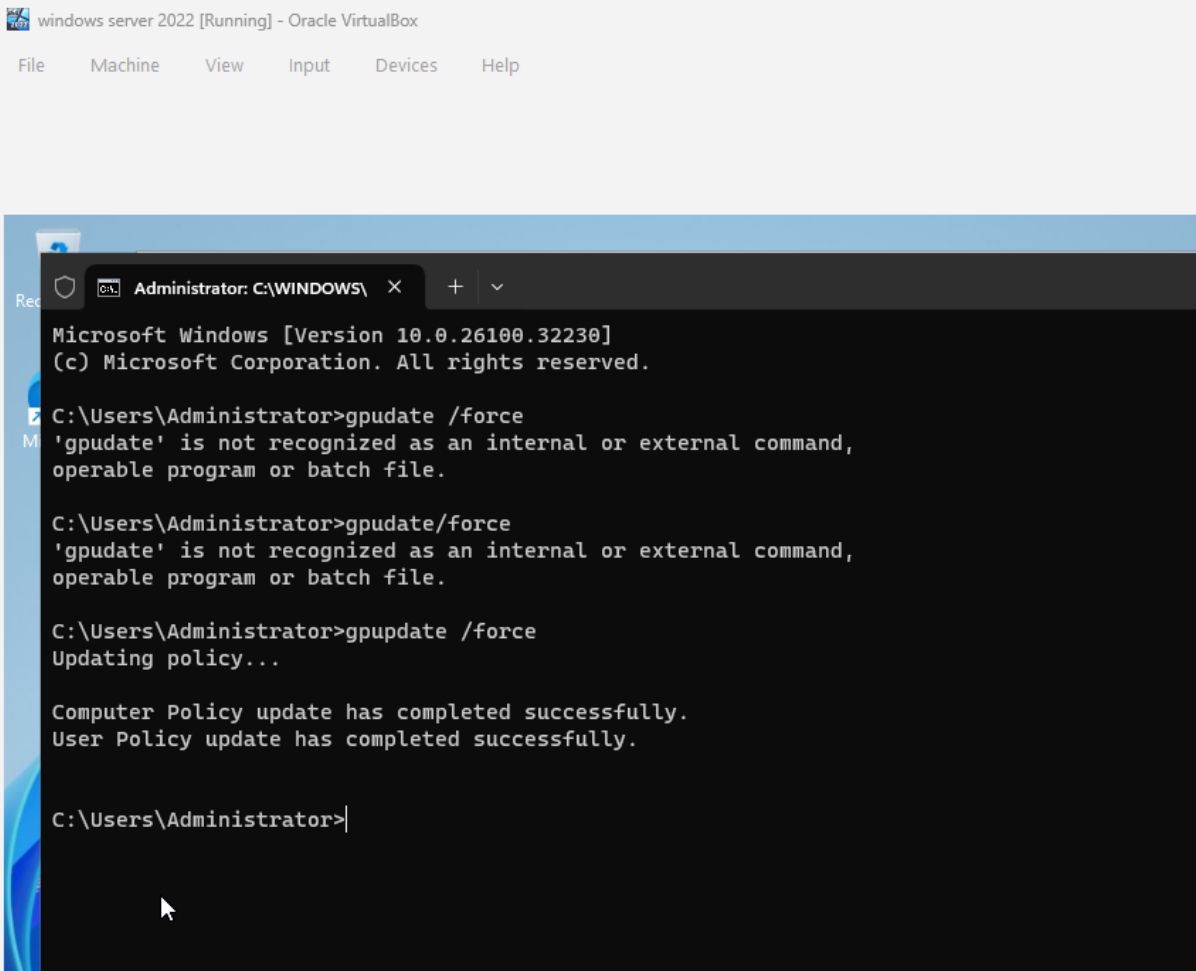
## Step 5 — Confirm GPO Link

Expand the Finance OU — Map Finance Drive is now visible, confirming the link is successful. Any user inside the Finance OU will receive the F: drive mapping when they log in.



## Step 6 — Verify David Lee is in Finance OU

This means the GPO will apply to David Lee because he is a user in the Finance department.



```
windows server 2022 [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help

Administrator: C:\WINDOWS\
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26100.32230]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\Administrator>gpupdate /force
'gpupdate' is not recognized as an internal or external command,
operable program or batch file.

C:\Users\Administrator>gpupdate/force
'gpupdate' is not recognized as an internal or external command,
operable program or batch file.

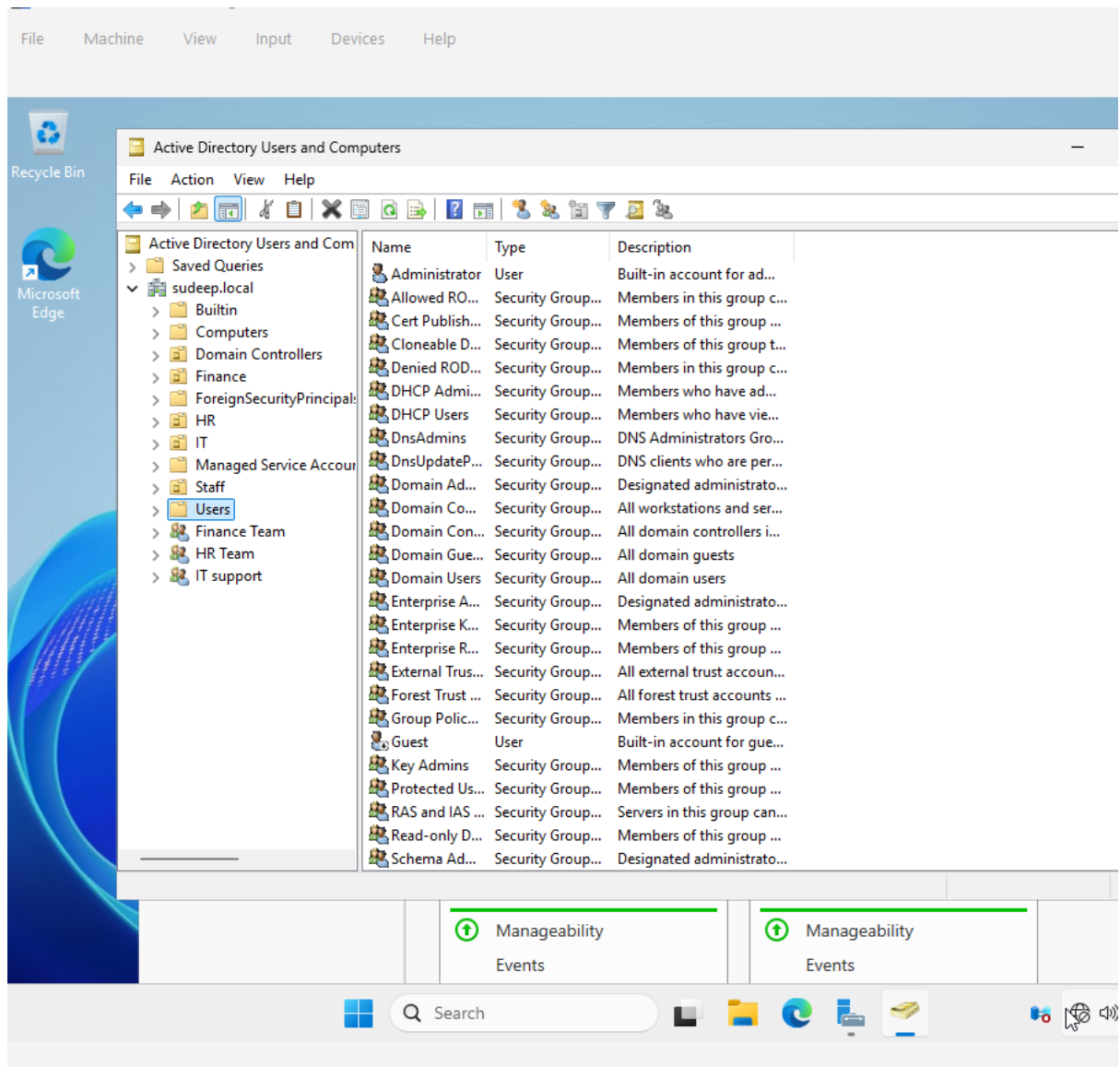
C:\Users\Administrator>gpupdate /force
Updating policy...

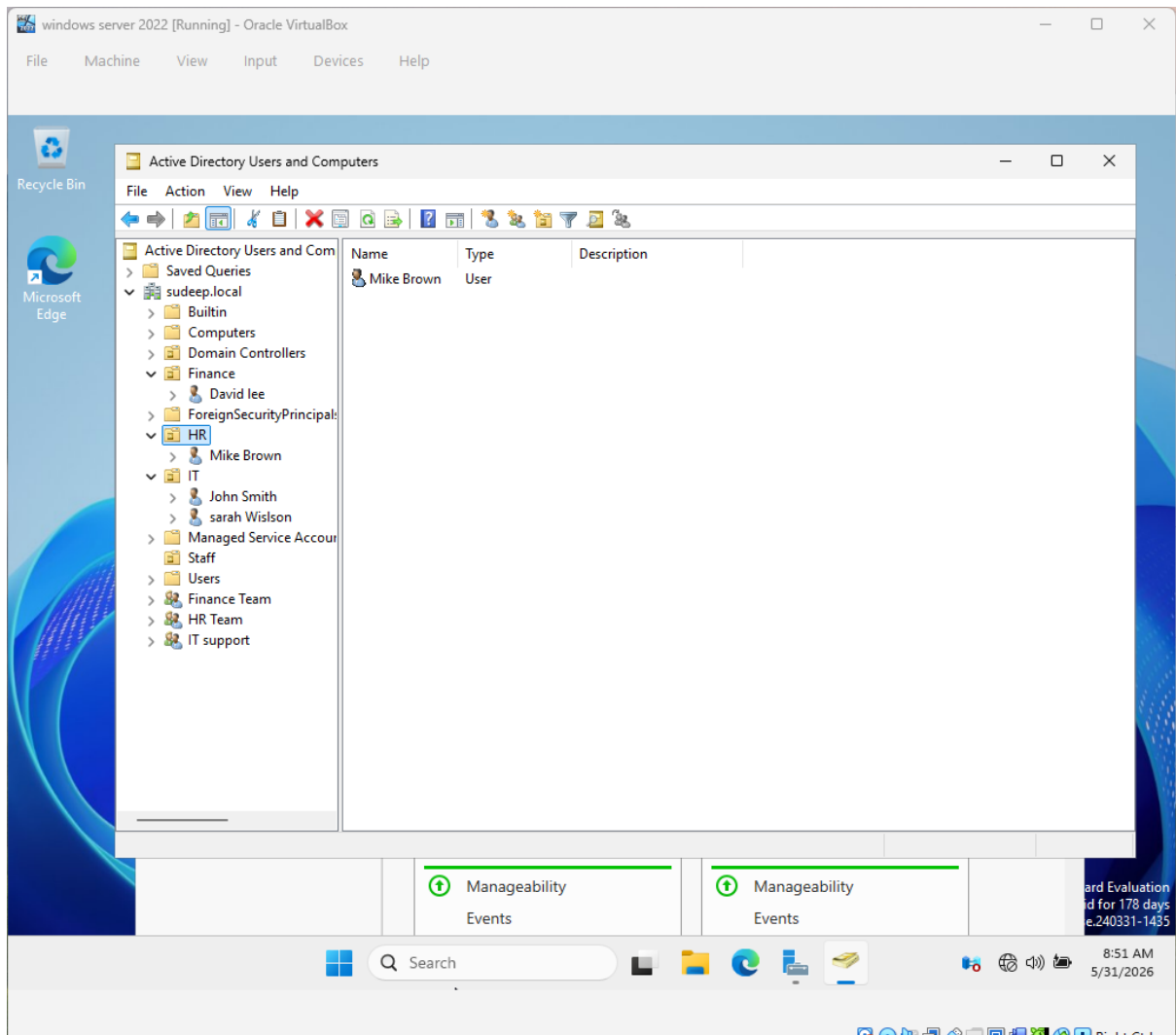
Computer Policy update has completed successfully.
User Policy update has completed successfully.

C:\Users\Administrator>
```

# Applying the Policy

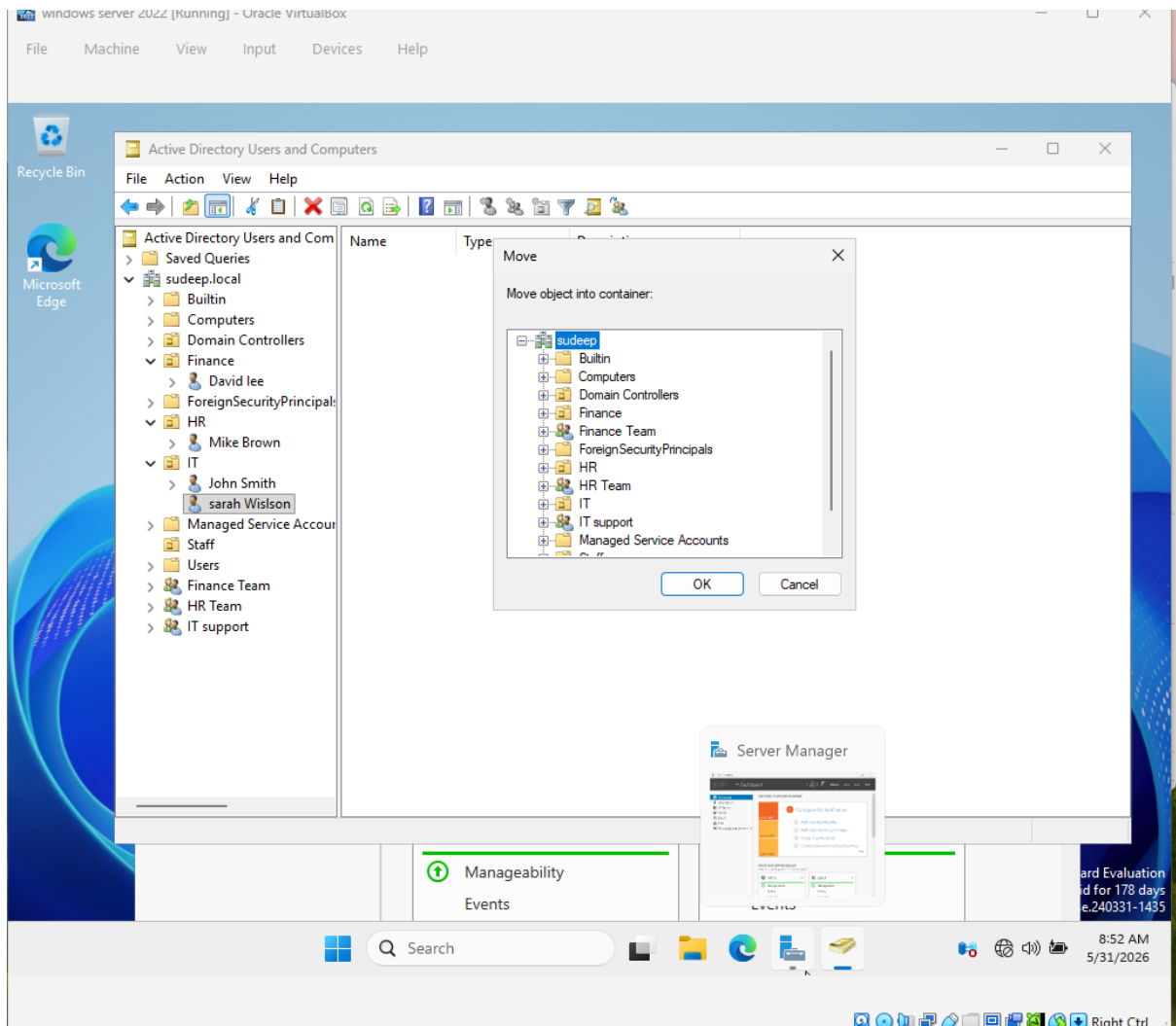
## Step 7 — Active Directory Overview



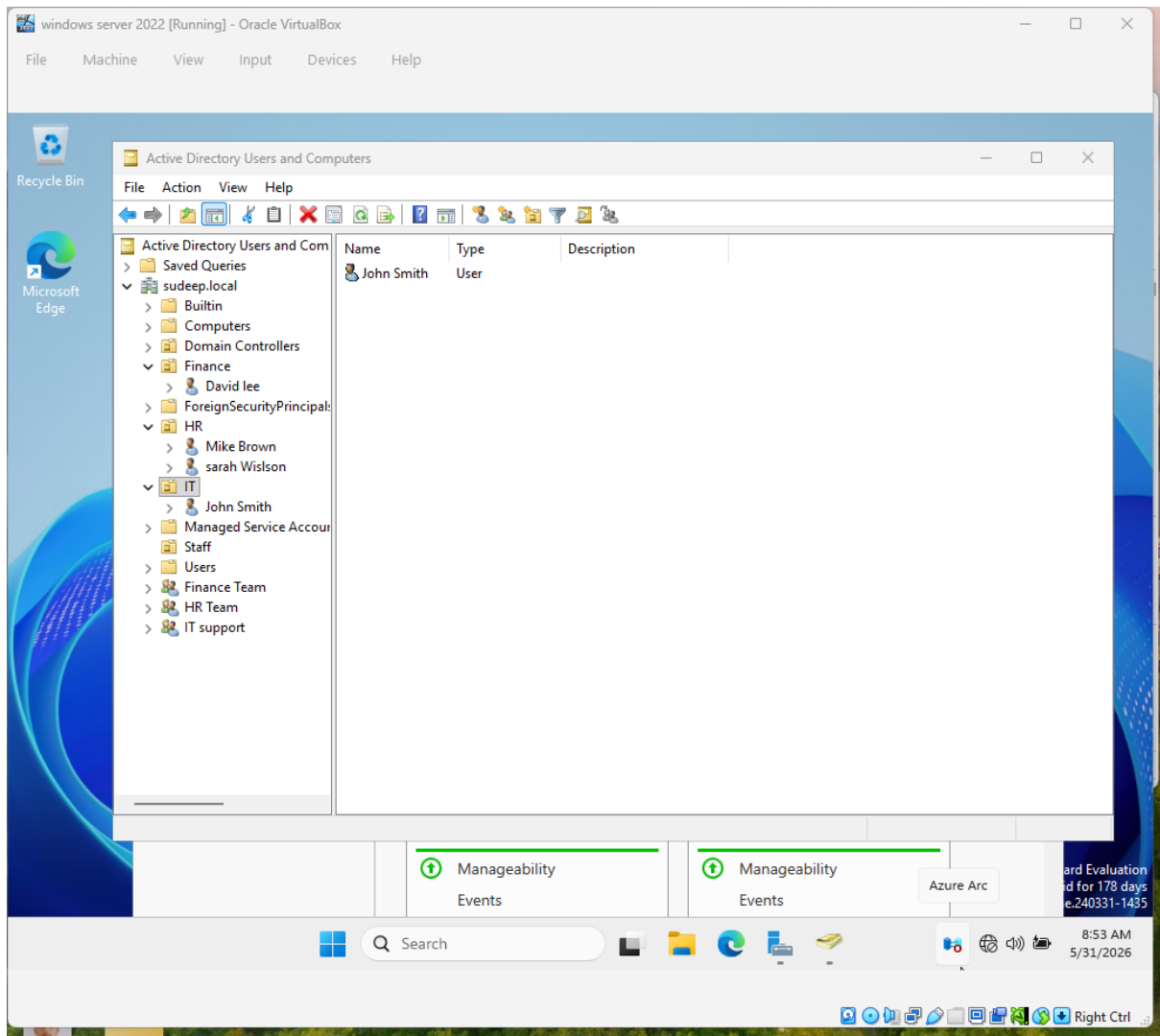


## Step 8 — Move Sarah Wilson to HR OU

Move Sarah Wilson to the HR Organisational Unit using Active Directory Users and Computers.

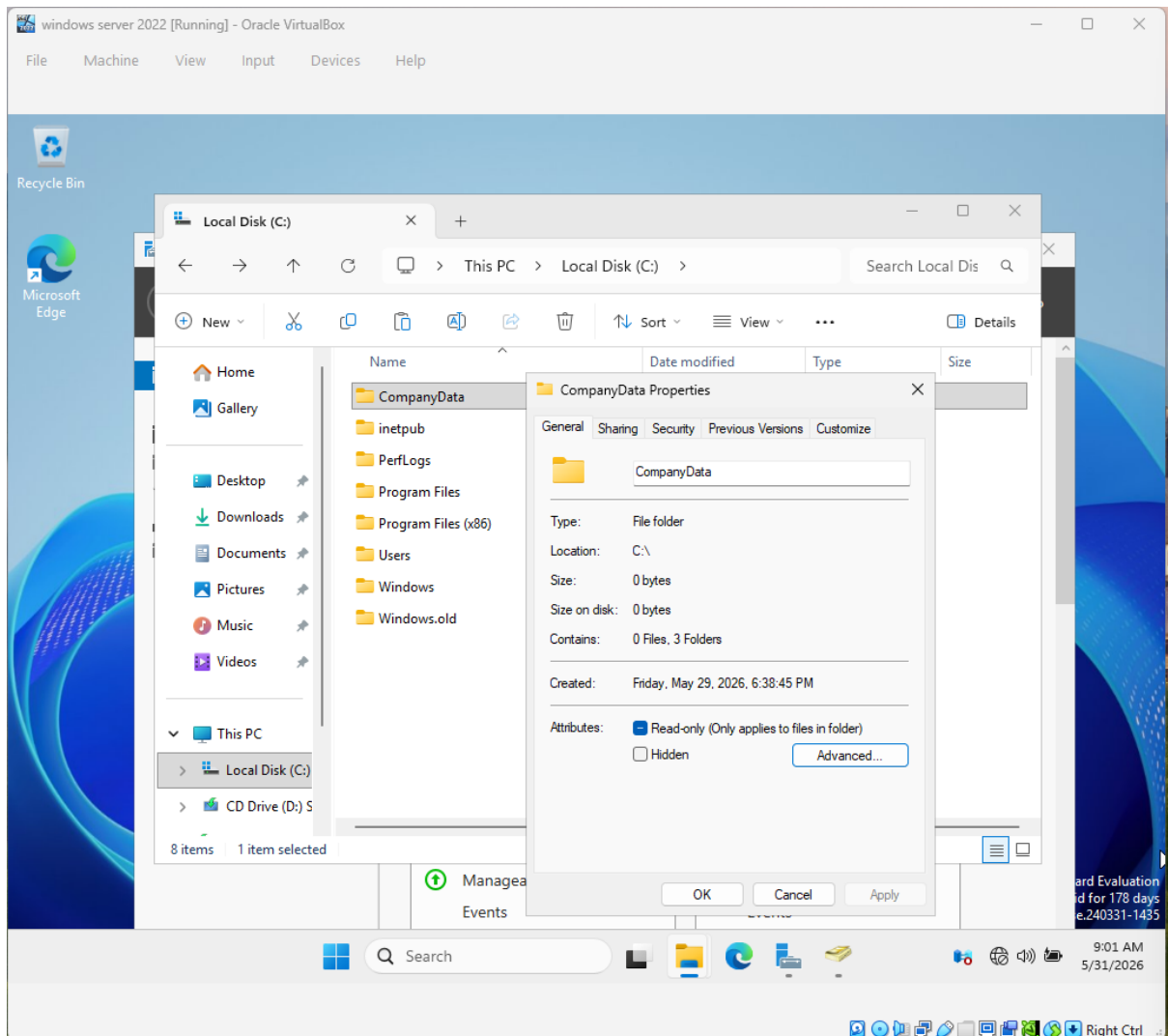


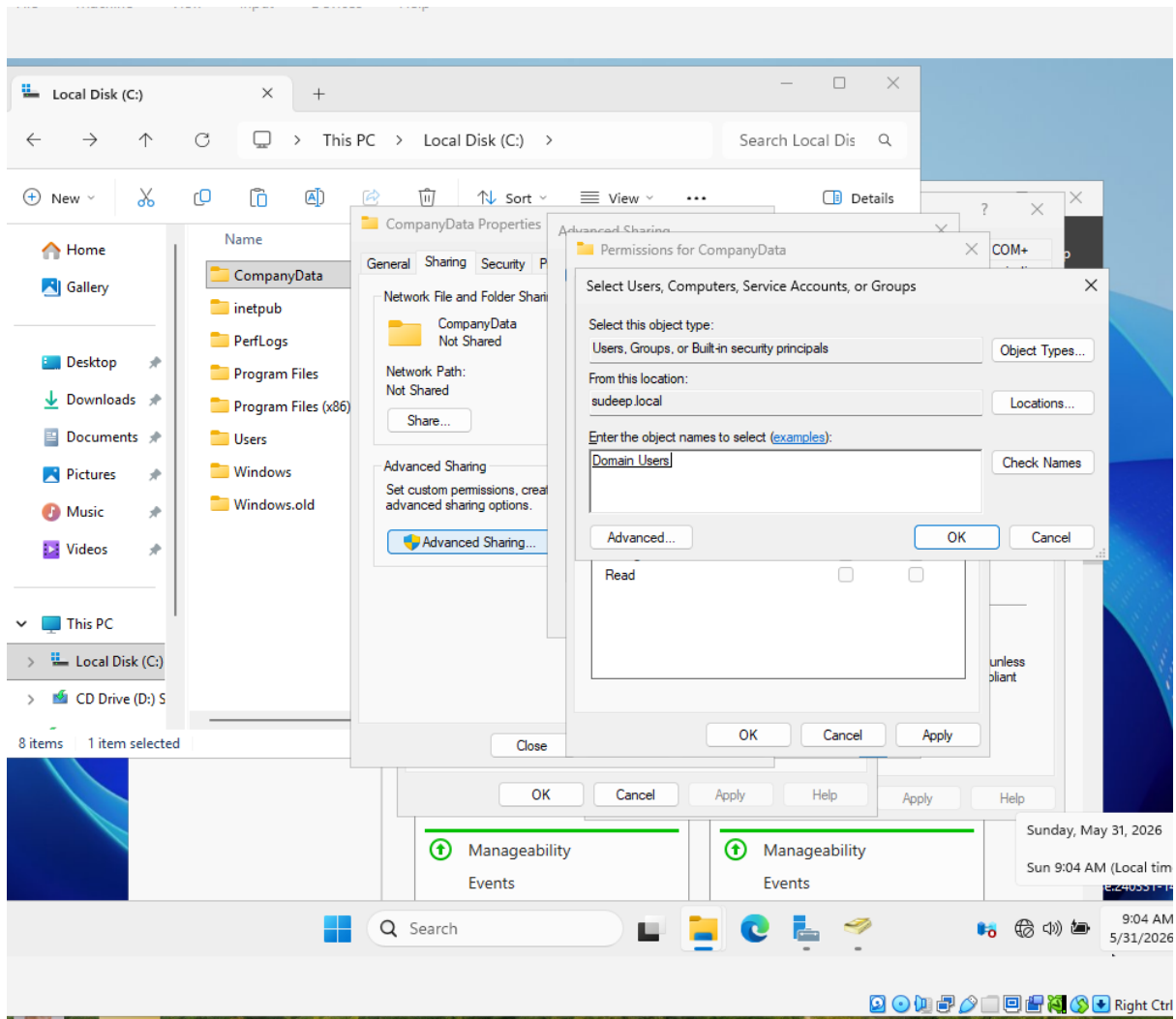




## Step 9 — Share CompanyData Folder to Domain Users

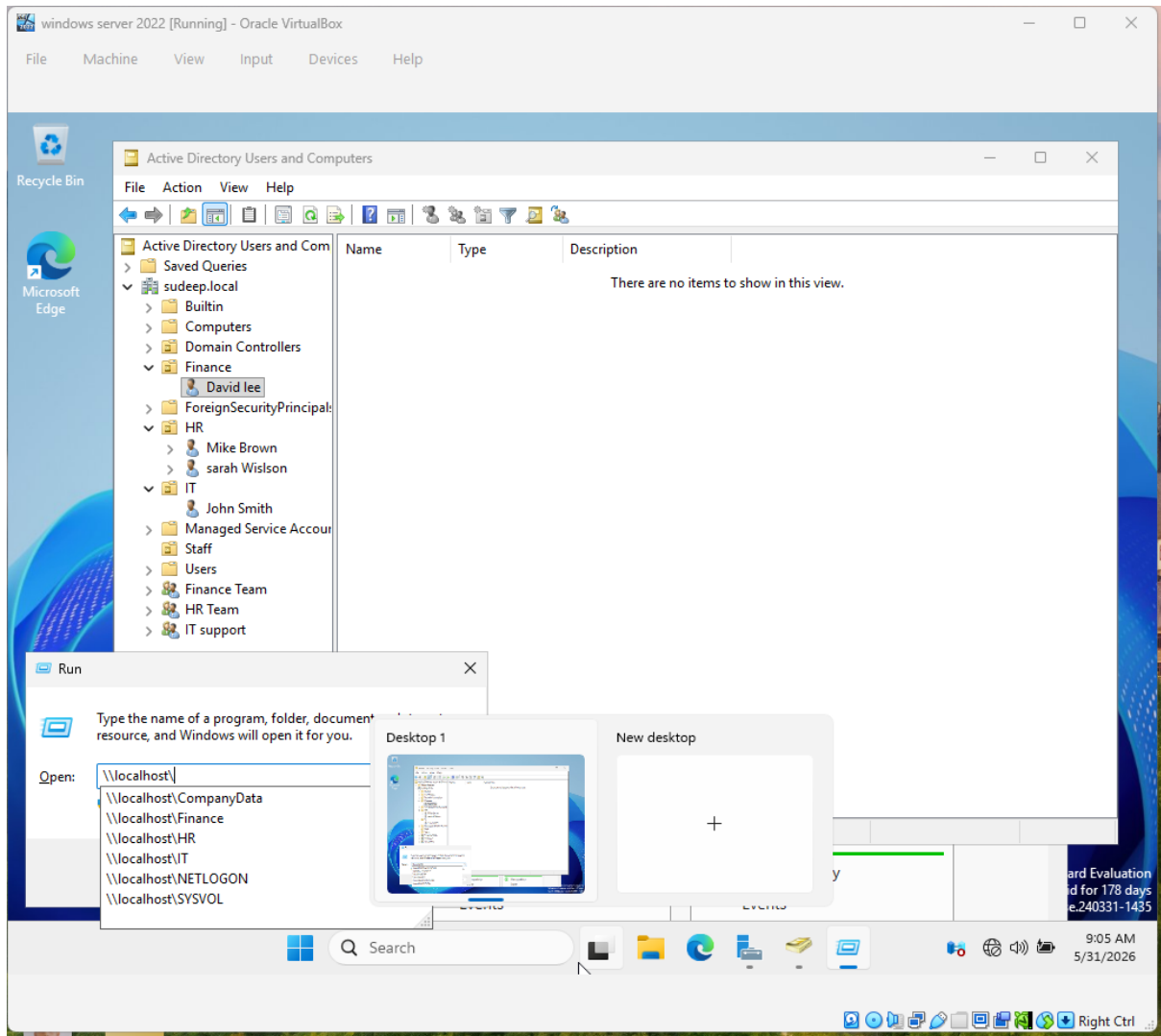
Configure sharing permissions on the CompanyData folder so domain users can access it.

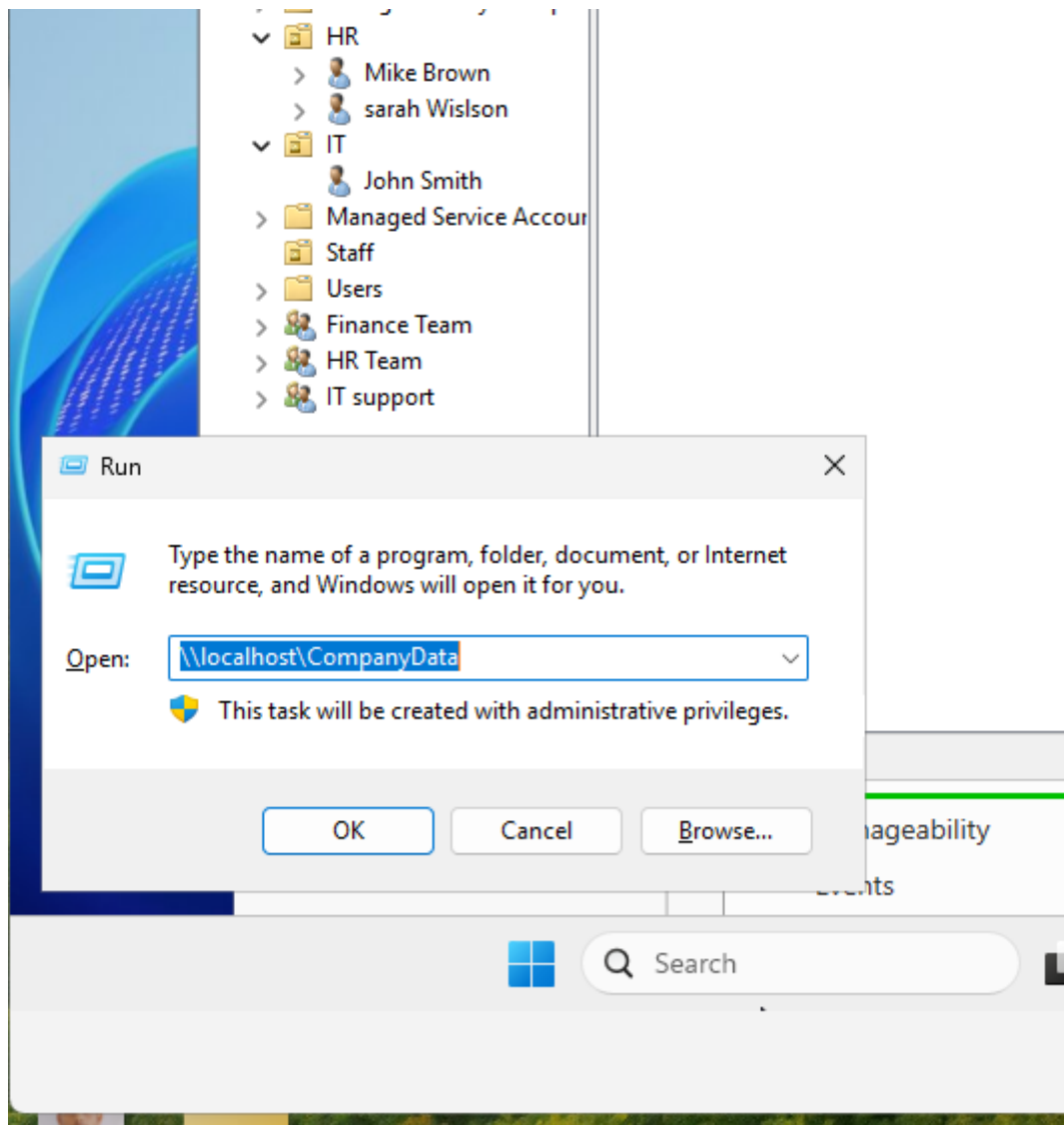


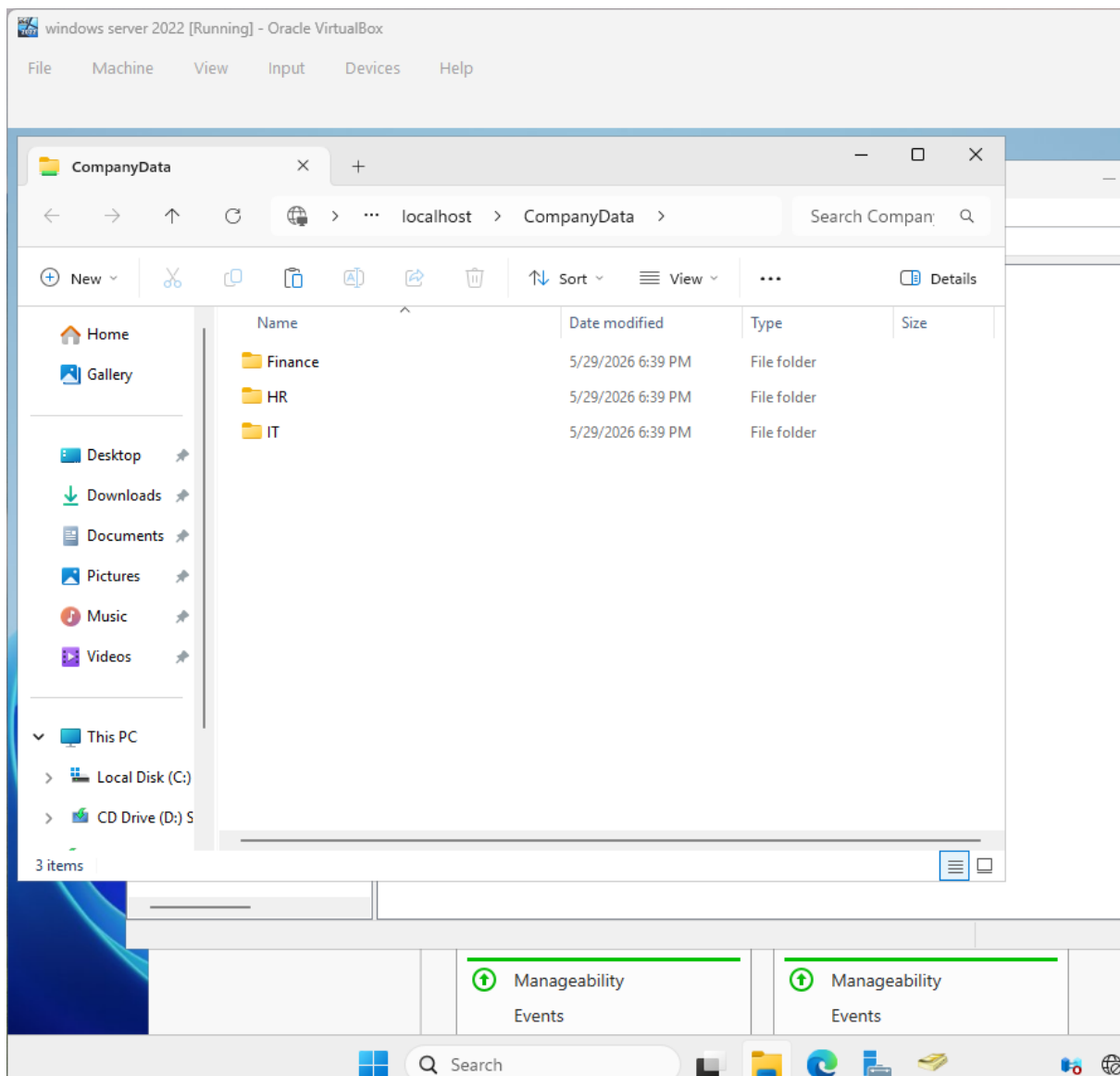


# Testing

## Step 10 — GPO Policy Update

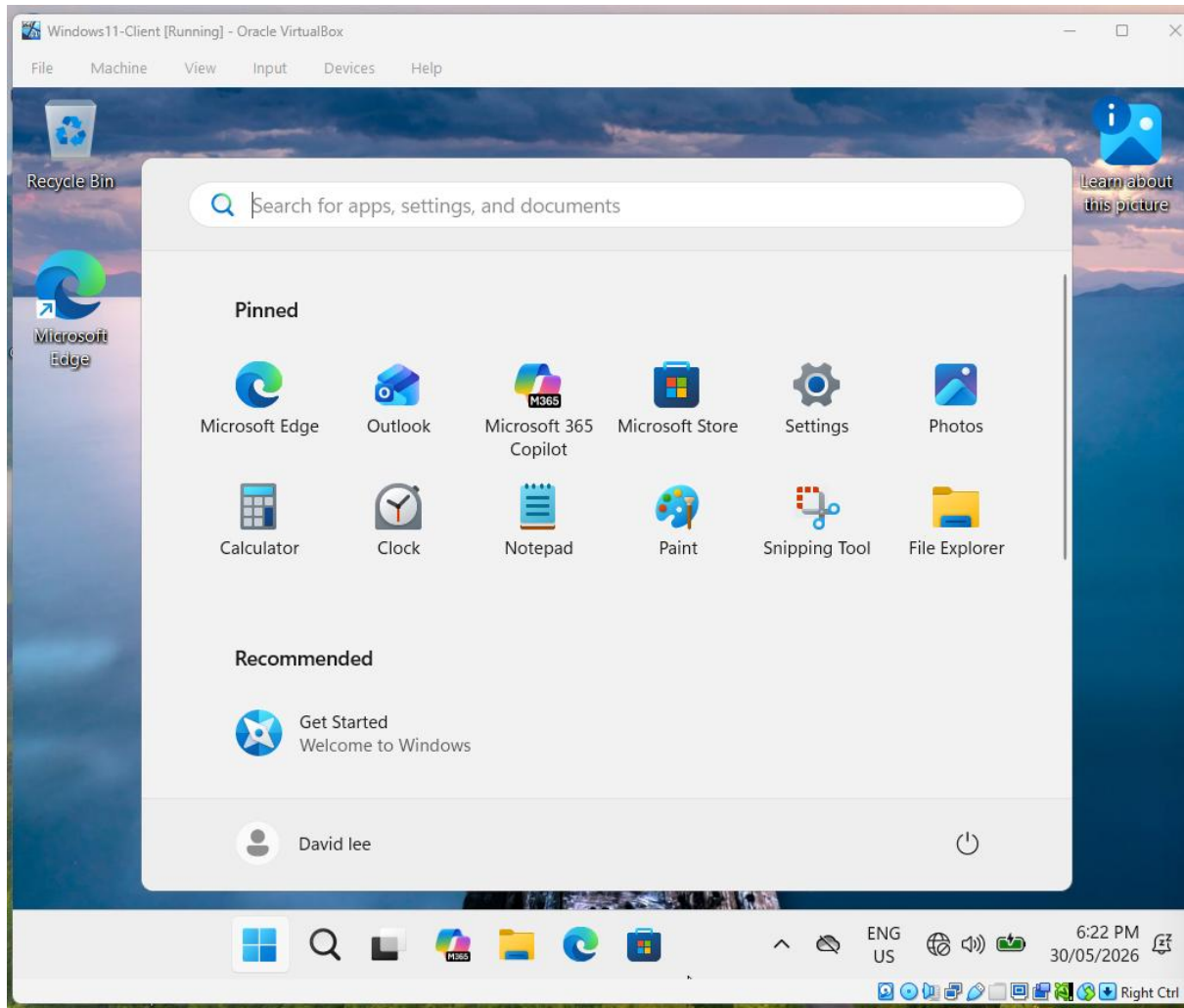






## Step 11 — Test David Lee's Account Login on Client01 VM

Log in as David Lee on the Client01 virtual machine to verify the F: drive mapping is applied automatically.



Windows11-Client [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox

File Machine View Input Devices Help

C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd. X + v

Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8457]  
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\dlee>gpupdate /force  
Updating policy...

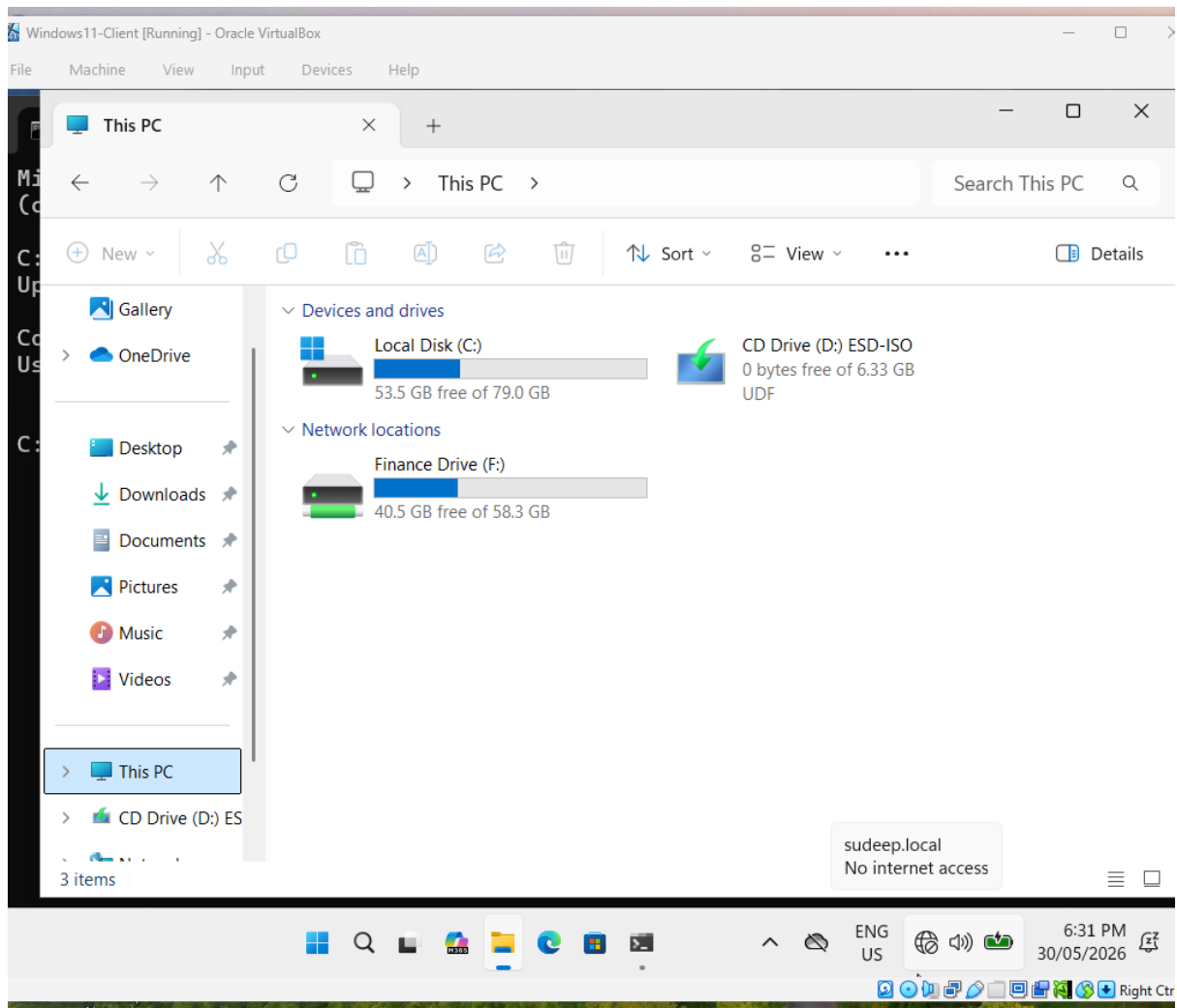
Computer Policy update has completed successfully.  
User Policy update has completed successfully.

C:\Users\dlee>|



## Step 12 — GPO Successfully Applied

The Domain Controller and Client01 are able to communicate. The most recent Group Policies were delivered to David Lee. The Finance OU GPO has been completed successfully.



## Conclusion

This lab demonstrated how to use Group Policy Management to automatically map network drives for domain users in a specific Organisational Unit. By creating and linking the Map Finance Drive GPO to the Finance OU, all users in that OU receive an F: drive mapping at login without manual configuration.

Skills developed include GPO creation, drive map preference configuration, OU-based policy linking, folder sharing, and end-to-end policy testing on a domain-joined client VM. These are core Active Directory administration skills relevant to IT Help Desk and Junior System Administrator roles.

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